Reading Comprehension English II

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Humayun Ahmed, the enduring storyteller

Humayun Ahmed was born on 13th November, 1948. He was a Bangladeshi author, dramatist, screenwriter, playwright and film maker. Humayun reached peak of his fame with the publication of his novel 'Nondito Noroke' (In Blissful Hell) in 1972. This is one of his most famous works and it won admiration from literary critics including Dr. Ahmed Sharif. He wrote over 100 fiction and non-fiction books; all of them were best sellers in Bangladesh.

In recognition to the works of Humayun, Times of India wrote that Humayun was a custodian of Bangladeshi literary culture, and his contribution single handedly shifted the capital of Bengali literature from Kolkata to Dhaka without any war or revolution. Ahmed's writing style was characterized as magic realism.

Humayun Ahmed, the enduring storyteller

Sunil Ganguly described him as the most popular writer in Bengali language for 21st century. According to him, Ahmed was even more popular than Sharat Chandra Chattapadday. Ahmed's books have been the top seller at the Ekushey Book Fair during the 1990s and 2000s.

In 2011, Ahmed was diagnosed with colorectal cancer. He died on 19th July, 2012 at 11.02 PM. BST at Bellevue Hospital in New York. He was buried in Nuhash Palli. Still the Bengali readers mourn something far more significant than the passing away of a writer; they grieve the death of a collective imagination which was personified by this man. (Edited)

Choose the best answer from the following:

1.Which of the following works brought Humayun Ahmed to the peak of his fame?

a) Debi
b) b) Shongkhonil Karagar
c) c) Nondito Noroke
d) d) Himu

- According to the passage, Humayun Ahmed wrote over _____ books.
- a) 50
- b) 75
- c) 100
- d) 150

- According to Times of India, Humayun Ahmed _____.

a) was the first Bangladeshi novelist
b) was a custodian of Bangladeshi literary culture
c) received the Nobel Prize
d) was mainly famous as a filmmaker

- In the passage, the word custodian is closest in meaning to:

a) Critic

b) Visitor

c) Guardian

d) Publisher

- According to Sunil Ganguly, Humayun Ahmed was _____.

a) the greatest playwright in Bangladesh
b) the most popular Bengali writer of the 21st century
c) the first Bangladeshi novelist
d) more popular than all international writers

- Humayun Ahmed was diagnosed with colorectal cancer in _____.

a) 2009

b) 2010

c) 2011

d) 2012

In the context of the passage, match the words with their meanings

- **Words:** critic, Fame, Publication, Contribution, Diagnosed, Custodian
- i. _____ a person who protects or takes care of something valuable
- ii. _____ identified as having a disease after a medical examination
- iii. _____ the act of producing and making a book available to the public
- iv. _____ a feeling of great respect and approval
- v _____ people who express opinions about books, films, or other works of art.
- vii. _____ something that helps to achieve or improve something

Write short answer to the following questions:

1. Why is Nondito Noroke considered an important novel in Humayun Ahmed's literary career?
2. How did Times of India evaluate Humayun Ahmed's contribution to Bengali literature?
3. What did Sunil Ganguly believe about Humayun Ahmed's position in Bengali literature?
4. What does the title “Humayun Ahmed, the most enduring storyteller” signify?
5. Why do you think Bengali readers mourned more than the passing away of a writer? Answer based on the passage.

- **Write a summary of the above passage in your own words**.

Summary :

- The passage deals with the life and literary achievements of Humayun Ahmed, one of the most renowned writers in Bangladesh. It states that he became famous after the publication of Nondito Noroke and later wrote more than one hundred bestselling books. Furthermore, his unique writing style and significant contribution to Bengali literature earned him admiration from critics and readers. Although he was diagnosed with colorectal cancer and died in 2012, his literary legacy continues to inspire people. Overall, the passage presents Humayun Ahmed as an exceptional writer whose works have left a lasting impact on Bengali literature.

Thank You
Any Questions?